

Usability testing

- Goals & questions focus on how well users perform tasks with the product.
- Comparison of products or prototypes is common.
- Focus is on time to complete task & number & type of errors.
- Data collected by video & interaction logging.
- Testing is central.
- User satisfaction questionnaires & interviews provide data about users' opinions.

Testing conditions

- Usability lab or other controlled space.
- Emphasis on:
 - selecting representative users;
 - developing representative tasks.
- 5-10 users typically selected.
- Tasks usually around 30 minutes
- Test conditions are the same for every participant.
- Informed consent form explains procedures and deals with ethical issues.

Types of data

- Time to complete a task.
- Time to complete a task after a specified time away from the product.
- Number and type of errors per task.
- Number of errors per unit of time.
- Number of times online help and manuals accessed.
- Number of users making an error.
- Number of users successfully completing a task.

How many participants is enough for user testing?

- The number is a practical issue.
- Depends on:
 - schedule for testing;
 - availability of participants;
 - cost of running tests.
- Typically 5-10 participants.
- Some experts argue that testing should continue until no new insights are gained.